

XENIX[®] System V/286 Operating System

Visual Shell User's Guide

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Chapter 1

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1.1 Introduction

The XENIX® Operating System Visual Shell is an interface between you and your computer's operating system. The Visual Shell can be used on any microprocessor running XENIX Version 3.0 or System V.

The user interface or "shell" is what you see on the screen when your system is waiting for a command. The shell interprets all commands to the operating system; it replaces the traditional command-line with a visual shell that shows you a menu of the most commonly executed applications and utilities.

As with Microsoft® Productivity™ software, pressing the **HELP** key or choosing the **Help** command displays **Help** information. Files for use with a command may be selected by pointing to a file or directory with the cursor. This saves you from having to type the whole filename or directory name, and reduces the possibility of selecting the wrong file or directory.

An important feature of the Visual Shell is that you can customize it for different purposes. You can create commands and help files as well as tailor the shell for different applications.

The Visual Shell typically will be used by people running prepackaged applications (such as Microsoft Multiplan®) under XENIX. Users with more advanced knowledge will customize the menus for more efficient running of applications and data processing.

In this chapter, we will define some terms and introduce you to the Visual Shell environment.

1.2 Getting Started

To use this manual you need to know how to log in to your computer. If your system has been customized with the Visual Shell, you will see the Visual Shell screen when you log in.

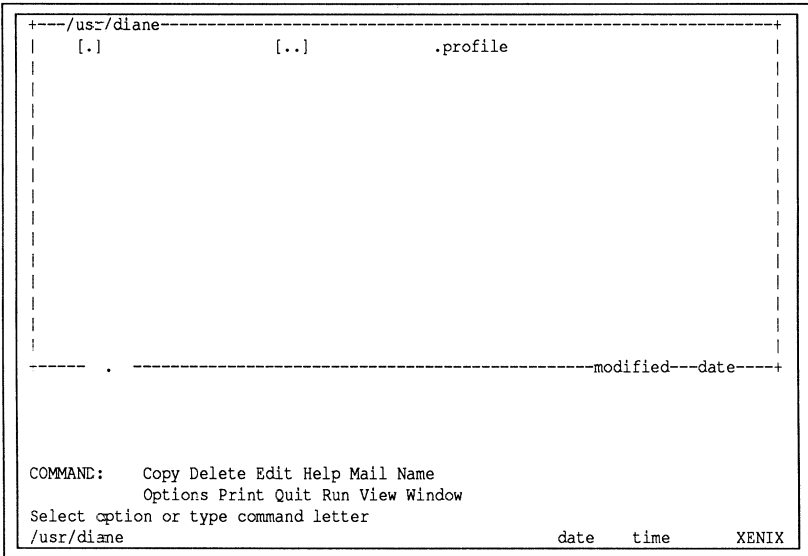
If your system has not been customized, you will see the "\$" prompt when you login. To start the Visual Shell from the "\$" prompt, type the following command:

```
vsh
```

Your screen is redrawn and the Visual Shell appears.

1.3 Command Screen

When you start the XENIX Visual Shell the first thing you will see is the command screen. Your screen may look something like this:



1.4 Output of Commands

The center portion of your screen appears blank when you start your computer. As you type commands, the output of these commands appears in the center portion of the screen. The command output scrolls up each time a new command is typed, until the directory window is reached. The output scrolls past the directory window as new output is displayed at the bottom. The command menu, message line, and status line are temporarily erased during command execution and are redrawn when the command has completed.

Normally, output in this area reflects the Visual Shell command you choose. A special command lets you see exactly which XENIX command you are running. See Section 6.11 of Chapter 6, "Command Directory," for more information.

1.5 Main Command Menu

The main command menu shows 12 commands:



Copy
Delete
Edit
Help
Mail
Name
Options
Print
Quit
Run
View
Window

You will use these commands to copy and delete files, run applications, quit the session, obtain **Help** text, and access many of the functions of the operating system. Below the menu is the prompt, “Choose option or type command letter.” You will learn how to choose options and type command letters in Chapter 3, “Using the Visual Shell.”

1.6 Status Line



The status line is the last line on the screen. It gives you the following information:

- The pathname of the working directory (left truncated if necessary).
- A message if you have mail.
- The date.
- The time.
- The name of the operating system (XENIX).

When the operating system is waiting for you to enter commands, two things are monitored and displayed on the status line: the time and the date. The time is updated every minute, and the date is updated daily.

1.7 Message Line



The message line is above the status line. The Visual Shell displays various messages on this line when you choose commands and execute operating system tasks. Any error messages you may receive appear on this line.

1.8 Definitions

You should understand the following terms when using the Visual Shell. These terms are defined in more detail in the *XENIX User's Guide*.

File	A file is a collection of related information. All programs, text, and data on your disks reside in files. You create a file each time you enter and save data or text at your terminal. Files are also created when you write and name programs and save them on your computer.
Filename	A filename is a string of up to 14 characters. Characters such as period (.) and hyphen (-) are allowed so you may create filename extensions that are used to identify types of files. An example of a filename with an extension is <i>newfile.mnu</i> . Refer to your <i>XENIX User's Guide</i> for more information on naming files.
Directory	The names of files are kept in directories on your computer. These directories also contain information on the size of the files, their location on disk, and the dates that they were created or modified. The directory you are working in is called your "working" directory.
Pathname	A pathname is a sequence of directory names followed by a simple filename, each separated from the previous one by a forward slash (/). Pathnames are used to uniquely identify files that may have the same name or that are not in your current working directory. An example of a pathname is <i>/usr/joel/testfile</i> .
Special Characters	The asterisk (*) and the question mark (?) special characters can be used when specifying filenames. These special characters give you greater flexibility when using filenames in XENIX commands.

The question mark (?) in a filename indicates any character occupying that position. The asterisk (*) in a filename indicates any character occupying that position or any of the remaining positions in the filename. For more information on using special characters, see the *XENIX User's Guide*.

Switches

Switches are options that control operating system commands. They appear on command menus as choices, as in the following example:

recursive: Yes (No)

The default choice is always enclosed in parentheses.

Filter

A filter is a command that reads your input, transforms it in some way, and then outputs it, usually to your terminal or to a file. In this way, the data is said to have been "filtered" by the program. Since filters can be put together in many different ways, a few filters can take the place of a large number of specific commands.

Pipes

If you want to have the output of one program sent as input to another, you can "pipe" commands to the operating system. For example, you may occasionally need to have the output of one program sent as the input to another program. A typical case would be a program that produces output in columns. In addition, you may want to have the columns sorted.

Piping with the Visual Shell is accomplished by typing a bar (|) symbol in the "output:" field of a command menu. The Visual Shell will then display a **Filter** menu. You can choose the appropriate filter (**Sort**, **More**, **Get**, etc.) and your program will be "piped" through that filter. You can also pipe programs and commands through your own filters.

You can pipe (redirect) the output of a command or program by specifying an output filename or device name in the "output:" command field.

1.9 Using This Manual

This manual contains examples that you can follow while learning XENIX. To help you follow the examples, refer to Chapter 5, “Key Directory,” for a list of key functions.

You can also use the **Help** command any time to find out which key to use to perform a function. Refer to Section 3.9, in Chapter 3, “Using the Visual Shell,” for more information.





Chapter 2

Choosing Commands

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2.1 Command Menus

The lists of commands you see on your screen are called menus. In fact, any time you see choices on the bottom part of the screen, that is a menu. You can choose an option from a menu by pressing the SPACEBAR. As you press the SPACEBAR, watch the command menu. The highlight moves left to right, stopping at each command. Try pressing the SPACEBAR to move to each of the different options on the main command menu. Once you have selected a command, press the RETURN key and a new menu will be displayed on the screen. You must fill in the blank fields of this submenu to tell the Visual Shell what to do with the command you selected.

The BACKSPACE key can be used to back up (move right to left) through the commands.

To get back to the main command menu at any time, press the CANCEL key. Refer to Chapter 5, “Key Directory,” for the key or keys that perform the Cancel function.

Another way to select commands and other options is to type the first letter of the command or option while in the command menu. For example, if you want to copy a file, type C. You do not need to press RETURN; the **C**opy command will automatically be processed.

Note

If you press a key that does not work as a command, such as the letter J, the command screen will not change, but you will see the error message, “Not a valid option.”

2.2 Editing Responses to Commands

The Visual Shell provides special editing keys to edit responses in the command fields. The following keys are listed by *function* only. Refer to Chapter 5, “Key Directory,” for the exact key or sequence of keys that corresponds to these functions.

The field containing a proposed response is highlighted just after a command is selected or after pressing the TAB key.

To *replace* the proposed response, type the replacement. The Visual Shell automatically deletes the proposed response as soon as you type the new one.

To *delete* the proposed response and leave the field empty, press the DELETE key. All text that is highlighted is deleted.

To *append* to the proposed response, press either the CHARACTER RIGHT or the WORD RIGHT key, then type the additional text.

Once the proposed response is altered, one character or word in the field is highlighted. This highlight is the edit cursor. The edit cursor may be moved to designate where or what to edit.

Use the CHARACTER LEFT, CHARACTER RIGHT, WORD LEFT, and WORD RIGHT keys to move the edit cursor in the command fields. The CHARACTER LEFT and CHARACTER RIGHT keys move the edit cursor left or right one character. The WORD LEFT and WORD RIGHT keys move the edit cursor left or right, choosing words or the space or punctuation between words.

To *insert* new text, type the text. It will be inserted in front of the edit cursor.

To *delete* text, use the BACKSPACE key to delete characters on the left side of the cursor. Use the DELETE key to delete what is highlighted by the cursor.

To *replace* text, delete the old text and type the new text.

2.3 Carrying Out a Command: The RETURN Key

The Visual Shell does not carry out the command until you tell it to do so by pressing the RETURN key. As shown earlier, the RETURN key is also used after you move the highlight to a command or subcommand name with the SPACEBAR or BACKSPACE keys.

You can press the RETURN key whenever the responses in all the command fields are correct. When a command has been carried out, the command screen reappears and waits for a new command. Note that if you choose a command by typing its first letter, you do not have to press the RETURN key.

2.4 Canceling a Command: The CANCEL Key

Before you press RETURN to carry out a command, you may press the CANCEL key to cancel the command. When you press the CANCEL key, the command screen will reappear and you can choose another command or quit the session. Refer to Chapter 5, "Key Directory," to locate the CANCEL key on your keyboard.

2.5 Redrawing the Screen: The REDRAW Key

You may clear your screen at any time during the computer session by pressing the REDRAW key. Consult Chapter 5, "Key Directory," to determine which key corresponds to the Redraw function.

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3.1 Introduction

This chapter discusses how to perform operating system functions by using Visual Shell commands. The topics include:

- Creating files.
- Managing files.
- Managing directories.
- Managing floppy disks.
- Sending and receiving mail.
- Running applications.
- Getting help.
- Quitting.

3.2 Creating Files

The Visual Shell includes a specific command to help you create and edit files. This command is called the **Edit** command.

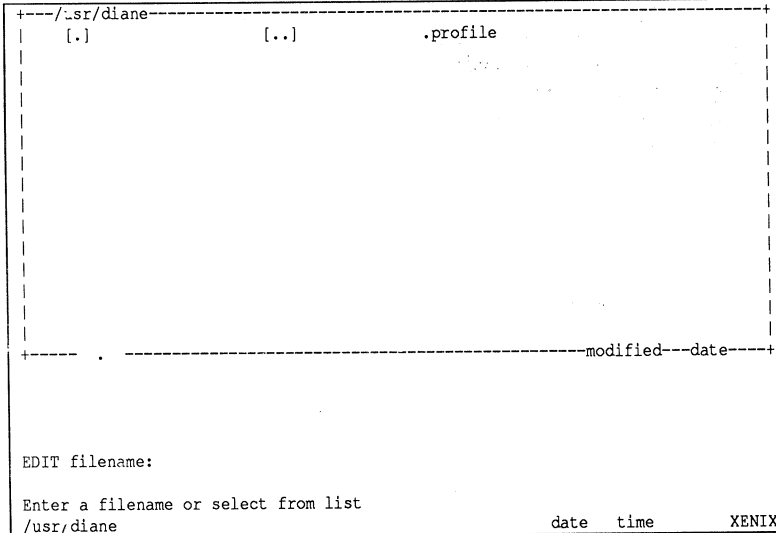
3.2.1 Using an Editor: The Edit Command

You can create and delete text and program files using the XENIX editor. The Visual Shell default editor for XENIX is **vi**. Refer to Chapter 4, "Using Advanced Features," for information on how to use other editors under XENIX.

You use the **Edit** command to automatically call up **vi**. When the **vi** menu appears, type the name of the file you want to create or edit, and then press the RETURN key. The Visual Shell will disappear and you will be using the editor. When you exit the editor, the Visual Shell is redisplayed.

Example

1. Choose the **Edit** command from the main command menu by typing the letter “E”. Your screen should look like this:



2. Type the filename *test* in the “filename:” command field.
3. Press the RETURN key.

The Visual Shell will disappear, and you will be using **vi**. (For more information on **vi**, see the *XENIX User's Guide*.)

4. Type the letter I (for “Insert”).
5. Type the following line:

I'm a XENIX Visual Shell temporary file.

- 3-2

3.2.2 Viewing Your Directory: The Direction Keys

You can scroll through your working directory anytime by pressing one of the direction keys: LEFT, RIGHT, UP, or DOWN. For example, to select the filename to the right of the current selection, press the RIGHT direction key.

3.3 Managing Files

The commands in this section will help you manage your files. The commands discussed are: **View**, **Copy**, **Delete**, **Name**, **Options**, and **Print**. These commands are used to view, copy, delete, rename, change permissions, and print files.

3.3.1 Viewing Files: The View Command

The **View** command is used to view files on the screen. You can scan through files using this command, but you cannot edit them. Use the **Edit** command to edit files.

To use the **View** command, choose the **View** command from the main command menu. Fill in the command menu with the name of the file you want to view. When you press the RETURN key, a fifteen-line window will appear at the top of the screen. The file you selected will be displayed in that window. If the file is larger than the window, you can use the direction keys and some function keys to scroll the file in the window. Refer to Chapter 5, “Key Directory,” for more information on function keys.

When the window appears on the screen, the main command menu will reappear. You can choose other Visual Shell commands while the window is on the screen.

Note

If you make a mistake, you can always press the CANCEL key to return to the main command menu. Refer to Chapter 5, “Key Directory,” for information on the CANCEL key.

Example

To view the *test* file that you created with the **Edit** command (refer to Section 3.2.1), follow these steps:

1. Choose the **View** command from the main command menu.
2. Fill in the menu by typing *test* in the “name:” command field. Your screen should look like this:

[illegible]

3. Press the RETURN key.

When you press the RETURN key, a window will open at the top of your screen. The *test* file will appear in this window.

3.3.2 Renaming Files: The Name Command

The **Name** command renames files. To use this command, choose the **Name** command from the main command menu. The **Name** menu will appear. Fill in the name of the file you want to rename in the “from:” command field, and the new name of the file in the “to:” command field. When you press RE-TJRN, your file will be renamed. You will know that the renaming process is complete when you see a message in the command output area of the screen.

You can rename any file according to the rules for naming files. Refer to the *XENIX User's Guide* for more information on naming conventions.

Example

To rename the *test* file *templ*, follow these steps:

1. Choose the **Name** command from the main command menu.
2. Fill in the **Name** menu as follows:

```

+---/usr/diane-----+
| I'm a XENIX Visual Shell temporary file.                  |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
+---.-----modified---date---+

"test" [New file] 1 line, 41 characters
NAME from: test           to: templ
Enter a filename or select from list
/usr/diane                date   time       XENIX

```

3. Press RETURN.

The *test* file is now renamed *templ*. You will see the message, "Name (1) test (2) templ" in the command output area of the screen.

3.3.3 Copying Files: The Copy File Command

The **Copy** command on the main command menu is used to copy files. It is also used to copy directories as described in Section 3.4.3.

To copy a file, choose the **Copy** command from the main command menu. The **Copy** menu will appear. This menu asks you whether you want to copy a file or a directory. When you choose **File**, the **Copy File** menu appears. You

must type the name of the file you want to copy in the “from:” command field, and the new name of the file in the “to:” command field.

Example

To make a copy of the *templ* file and name the copy *temp2*, follow these steps:

1. Choose **Copy** from the main command menu.
2. Choose **File** from the **Copy** menu.
3. Fill in the **Copy File** menu command fields. Your screen should look like this:

```
+---/usr/diane-----+  
|.|               |..|           .profile         templ      |  
|                   |                   |                   |  
|                   |                   |                   |  
|                   |                   |                   |  
|                   |                   |                   |  
|                   |                   |                   |  
|                   |                   |                   |  
|                   |                   |                   |  
|                   |                   |                   |  
|                   |                   |                   |  
+-----templ-----44 bytes-----modified---date--+  
"test" [New file] 1 line, 41 characters  
  
Name (1) test (2) templ  
  
COPY FILE from: templ              to: temp2  
  
Enter a filename or select from list  
/usr/diane                               date    time        XENIX
```

4. Press the RETURN key.

The message, “Copy File (1) temp1 (2) temp2” will appear in the command output area of the screen when the *temp1* file has been copied. You now have two identical files in your working directory: *temp1* and *temp2*.

3.3.4 Deleting Files: The Delete Command

You can delete files and directories with the **Delete** command. For information on deleting directories, refer to Section 3.4.4.

To delete a file, choose **Delete** from the main command menu. Fill in the name of the file you wish to delete in the “name:” command field. When you press RETURN, your file will be deleted. You will see a message in the command output area of the screen.

Example

To delete the file *temp2* from your working directory, follow these steps:

1. Choose the **Delete** command from the main command menu.
2. Type *temp2* in the “name:” command field.
3. Press RETURN.

The file *temp2* is deleted. You will see the message, “Delete (1) temp2” in the command output area of the screen.

3.3.5 Printing Files: The Print Command

The **Print** command is used to print files. To print a file, choose the **Print** command from the main command menu. The **Print** menu will appear. This menu contains a “filename:” command field. To print a file or files, type the name of the file in the “filename:” command field. When you press RETURN, your file will be sent to the printer. The message, “Print (1) filename” will be displayed in the command output area.

To print more than one file, separate the filenames with spaces when you fill in the “filename:” command field.

Note

Please make sure your printer is attached to your computer.

Example

To print the file *temp1*:

1. Choose the **Print** command from the main command menu.
2. Type *temp1* in the “filename:” command field. Your screen should

look like this:

[illegible]

3. Press the RETURN key.

The *temp1* file is sent to the printer. When it has been printed, the Visual Shell will display the message, "Print (1) temp1" in the command output area of the screen.

3.3.6 Setting File Permissions: The Options Permissions Command

The **Options** command is one of the Visual Shell commands that has a submenu of other commands. (The other Visual Shell commands with submenus are **Copy** and **Mail**). Use the **Options** command to set file permissions to protect various files in your directory. You can set the file permission to a variety of combinations.

To set a file permission, choose the **Options** command from the main command menu. An **Options** menu will appear. Now, choose the **Permissions** command. Fill in the command fields with the name of the file you wish to protect and with the kind of protection desired. When you press RETURN, the permission will change on your file.

3.4.1 Creating a Directory: The Options Directory Make Command

The **Options** menu contains several commands that perform directory functions. The **Options Directory Make** command creates new directories on your system. To create a directory, choose the **Options** command from the main menu. An **Options** menu will appear. Select the **Directory** command. The **Options Directory** menu will appear. When you choose the **Make** command, you will be asked to supply the name of the directory. You must supply a complete pathname if the directory is not a subdirectory of your working directory.

Example 1

Assume that your working directory is named */usr/diane*. You want to create a *forms* directory under *diane*. Follow these steps:

1. Choose the **Options** command from the main command menu.
2. Choose the **Directory** command.
3. Choose the **Make** command from the **Directory** menu.

4. Fill in the **Directory Make** menu as follows:

[illegible]

5. Press RETURN.

The message, “(1) forms” will be displayed in the command output area when XENIX has created the directory.

Example 2

Assume that your working directory is `/usr/diane`. To create a *memo* sub-directory directory in *forms*, follow these steps:

1. Choose the **Options** command from the main command menu.
2. Choose the **Directory** command.
3. Choose the **Make** command from the **Directory** menu.
4. Fill in the **Directory Make** menu with the complete *pathname* of the directory you want to make. Your screen should look like this:

[illegible]

5. Press RETURN.

3.4.2 Transferring to Other Directories: The View Command

If you want to change to another directory and look at the files in that directory, use the **View** command to transfer to the new directory. To use the **View** command, choose **View** from the main command menu. Type the name of the directory you want to transfer to in the “name:” command field. When you press RETURN, your working directory will be the directory you selected. The status line will change to reflect that you are now working in a different directory.

When you learn to use the Visual Shell window, you can use special keys to transfer to various directories. Section 4.2.1 in Chapter 4, “Using Advanced Features,” tells you more about changing directories.

Example

Assume your working directory is `/usr/diane`. You want to change to another user's directory, `/usr/sally`. Follow these steps:

1. Choose the **View** command from the main command menu.

2. Type `/usr/sally` in the “name:” command field. Your screen should look like this:

[illegible]

3. Press the RETURN key.

Your working directory will now be */usr/sally*. To check this, look at the status line at the bottom of your screen. This line keeps track of your working directory. Use the **View** command to return to your working directory.

3.4.3 Copying Directories: The Copy Directory Command

You can copy directories with the **Copy Directory** command. First, choose the **Copy** command from the main command menu. Then, choose **Directory** from the **Copy** menu. Type the *pathname* of the directory you want to copy in the “from:” command field. Type the new *pathname* of the directory in the “to:” command field. If you want all subdirectories of the directory copied also, choose “Yes” in the “recursive:” command field. The default is “No.” When you press RETURN, your directory will be copied, and the message, “Copy Directory (1) filename (2) filename” will appear in the command output area of the screen.

Example

To make a copy of the `/usr/diane/forms` directory and name the directory `/usr/diane/letters`, follow these steps:

1. Choose **Copy** from the main command menu.
2. Choose **Directory** from the **Copy** menu.
3. Fill in the command fields so that your screen looks like this:

[illegible]

4. Press RETURN.

You now have two identical directories:

- */usr/diane/forms.*
- */usr/diane/letters.*

3.4.4 Deleting Directories: The Delete Command

You can delete directories with the **Delete** command. First, choose the **Delete** command from the main command menu. Type the *pathname* of the directory

you want to delete in the “name:” command field. When you press RETURN, the directory will be deleted. The message, “Delete (1) pathname” will be displayed in the command output area of the screen.

Note

You cannot delete a directory unless it is empty (contains no files).

Example

Assume that you have a */usr/diane/tmp* directory on your disk. To delete the */usr/diane/tmp* directory, follow these steps:

1. Delete each file from the directory using the **Delete** command on the main command menu.
2. When the directory is empty, choose **Delete** from the main command menu.
3. Type */usr/diane/tmp* in the “name:” command field.
4. Press RETURN.

The */usr/diane/tmp* directory is now deleted.

3.4.5 Setting Directory Permissions: The Options Permissions Command

You can set different directory permissions with the **Options Permissions** command. To set a permission on a directory, follow the same steps outlined in Section 3.3.6 for files. Type the pathname of the directory you want to protect in the “name:” command field. When you press RETURN, the protection for your directory will have changed.

3.5 Listing Permissions: The Run Command

You can check the permissions that are set on both files and directories by using the Visual Shell Run command and “running” the XENIX **ls -l** (for “list”) command. Follow these steps:

1. Choose **Run** from the main menu.

2. When the **Run** menu appears, type “ls” in the “file:” command field.
3. Move to the “parameters” field and type “-l”.
4. Press RETURN.

Your working directory and files will be displayed in the command output area of the screen. Protection values for each file and directory are also displayed.

3.6 Managing Floppy Disks

The commands in this section will help you manage your disks. The commands discussed are on the **Options Filesystem** menu. They are: **Create**, **Filescheck**, **Spacefree**, **Mount**, and **Unmount**. The following table describes these commands:

Command	Task
Create	Creates a file system on a disk.
Filescheck	Checks the files for bad sectors; fixes disks.
Spacefree	Tells you how much space is left on the disk.
Mount	Allows you to “mount” (insert and use) a floppy disk.
Unmount	Allows you to “unmount” (take out) a floppy disk.

3.6.1 Creating a File System on a Disk

You cannot mount a floppy disk unless it has a file system on it. Use the **Options Filesystem Create** command to create a file system on a floppy disk.

To create a file system disk on a floppy disk, follow these steps:

1. Insert a formatted floppy disk into your system’s floppy disk drive.
2. Choose the **Options Filesystem Create** command.
3. Fill in the appropriate fields.
4. Press RETURN.

Warning:

If you create a file system on a floppy disk, then any data previously stored on that disk is destroyed.

Example

The following example creates a file system on a floppy disk. A file system is created on the disk in the floppy disk drive named `/dev/fd0`. The disk is then mounted.

1. Insert a formatted disk into your computer's floppy disk drive (`/dev/fd0`).
2. Choose **Options** from the main command menu.
3. Choose **Filesystem** from the **Options** menu.
4. Choose **Create** from the **Filesystem** menu.
5. Create a file system named `/dev/fd0` on the floppy disk by filling in the command fields as follows:

[illegible]

6. Press RETURN.

3.6.2 Mounting a Floppy Disk

To mount a floppy disk on your computer, follow these steps:

1. Create an empty directory in your working directory. A common name for this directory is *mnt*. If you already have an empty directory, you may use that directory instead. (For information on making directories, refer to Section 3.4.1.)
2. Insert a floppy disk containing a file system into your system's floppy disk drive.
3. Mount the floppy disk with the **Options Filesystem Mount** command.

You are now ready to use the floppy disk. If the mount is unsuccessful, use the **Options Filesystem Filesystemcheck** command to check the disk. Refer to Section 3.6.4.

Example

You can mount the contents of the floppy disk's file system in an empty directory with the **Mount** command. Follow these steps:

1. Insert a floppy disk with a file system into your computer's floppy disk drive (*/dev/fd0*).
2. Choose **Options** from the main command menu.
3. Choose **Filesystem** from the **Options** menu.
4. Choose **Mount** from the **Filesystem** menu.
5. Mount the disk (*/dev/fd0*) in the empty directory you created (*/usr/diane/mnt*) by filling in the command fields so that your screen looks like this:

```
+---/usr/diane-----+
|      [.]            [..]          .profile      [forms]
|      templ          [letters]     [mnt]
|
|
|
|
|
|
|
|
+---forms-----modified---date---+
m/n = 3 13.sp

Options Directory Make (1) mnt

OPTIONS FILESYSTEM MOUNT device: /dev/fd0    directory: /usr/diane/mnt
                             read only: Yes (No)

Enter new path
/usr/diane                                     date   time       XENIX
```

6. Press RETURN.

You can use the floppy disk simply by transferring to the `/usr/diane/mnt` directory with the **View** command. If you do not know how to transfer to another directory, refer to Section 3.4.2.

3.6.3 Unmounting a Floppy Disk: The Unmount Command

To remove a mounted floppy disk from a floppy disk drive, you must first “unmount” the disk. That is, you must break the connection between the operating system and your floppy disk. You do this with the **Options Filesystem Unmount** command. Follow these steps carefully:

1. Transfer to a directory other than the “mounted” directory. For example, transfer to the `/usr/diane` directory. Use the **View** command to transfer to a different directory.
2. Choose **Options** from the main command menu.
3. Choose **Filesystem** from the **Options** menu.
4. Choose **Unmount** from the **Filesystem** menu.
5. Type the disk drive name in the “device name:” command field.

6. Press RETURN.
7. Take out the floppy disk.

3.6.4 Checking Floppy Disks: The Filescheck Command

If you cannot mount a floppy disk, it is wise to run it through **Filescheck**. Refer to Chapter 6, “Command Directory,” for more information on the **Options Filesystem Filescheck** command.

To check a floppy disk, choose **Options** from the main command menu. Next, choose the **Filesystem** command. A **Filesystem** menu will appear. Choose **Filescheck**. Fill in the “device:” command field with the name of the floppy disk drive. When you press RETURN, the Visual Shell reports on the status of the disk, and fixes any problems (such as bad sectors).

Note

Using **Filescheck** may remove data from damaged portions of the disk, making the data inaccessible.

3.7 Running Applications: The Run Command

The **Run** command helps you run applications. These applications can be batch files that you create with an editor (using the **Edit** command), spreadsheet programs such as Microsoft® Multiplan®, and high-level language programs, such as C).

When you choose the **Run** command, the following **Run** menu appears:

```

+---/usr/diane-----+
|      [.]           [..]           .profile       [forms]      |
|      templ        [letters]      [mnt]           |
|                                                     |
|                                                     |
|                                                     |
|-----forms-----modified---date-----+
Options Filesystem Mount (1) /dev/fd0 (2) /usr/diane/mnt (3) No
Options Filesystem Unmount (1) /dev/fd0

RUN file:           parameters:           output:

Enter a filename or select from list
/usr/diane                                     date   time       XENIX

```

Since the **Run** command can be used for many different files and applications, the **Run** menu provides space to tell the operating system what you want to run and how to run it. The “file:” command field is used to specify which program or command to run. The “parameters:” field is used to specify any arguments that the operating system may need to run the program or command. Any special switches for the command or program should be typed in the “parameters:” command field.

You can use the “output:” field to direct output from the application or command to another file or device; or you can access the **Filter** menu by placing a bar (!) symbol in this field. (See below for more information on the **Filter** menu.) When you press the RETURN key, your application will run. When you exit your application, the main command menu is redisplayed.

3.7.1 Using Filters

A filter is a command that reads your input, transforms it in some way, and then outputs it, usually to your terminal or to a file. In this way, the data is said to have been “filtered” by the program. Since filters can be put together in many different ways, a few filters can take the place of a large number of specific commands. Visual Shell filters include: **Count**, **Get**, **Head**, **More**, **Sort**, and **Tail**. The following list describes these filters. The corresponding XENIX command name is enclosed in parentheses. If you need more information on these commands, look in the *XENIX Reference Manual* under the

XENIX command name.

Filter	Task
Count	Counts lines, words, and characters (wc).
Get	Searches files for a pattern (grep).
Head	Displays the first few lines of a file (head).
More	Displays files 23 lines at a time (more).
Sort	Sorts files (sort).
Tail	Displays the last part of a file (tail).

You can access the Visual Shell filters by placing a bar (|) symbol in the “output:” command field of certain command menus. The **Filter** menu will appear. When you choose an appropriate filter and press RETURN, your program or command will be piped through that filter. Example 2, below, illustrates how to access the **Sort** filter.

Note

For more information on piping XENIX commands, refer to the *XENIX User's Guide*.

The **Filter** menu includes a **Run** command. This command is used to access filters you have written. To run a command through your own filter, choose the **Run** command from the main command menu. Type the name of the command in the “file:” command field, and type a bar symbol (|) in the “output:” field. Select the **Run** command on the **Filter** menu. Type the filename associated with your filter in the “file:” field. When you press RETURN, the command will be piped through your filter. Example 3 illustrates this process.

Three examples are provided below. The first example illustrates how to start a software application package, Microsoft Multiplan, with the **Run** command. The second example shows you how to access a XENIX command not on the command menu and how to use the **Filter** menu. Example 3 describes how to pipe a XENIX command through a filter that you have written.

Example 1: Running an Application

To run Microsoft Multiplan, follow these steps:

1. Make sure that Multiplan exists on your computer. If it is on a floppy disk, mount the floppy disk before proceeding to step 2.
2. Choose the **Run** command from the main command menu.
3. When the **Run** command menu appears, type “Multiplan” in the “file:” command field. Your screen should look like this:

```
+---/usr/diane-----+
|  [.]                [...]    .profile    [forms]          |
|    templ            [letters] [mnt]                                     |
|                                                                    |
|                                                                    |
|                                                                    |
|                                                                    |
|                                                                    |
|                                                                    |
|                                                                    |
|                                                                    |
|                                                                    |
+---forms-----modified---date---+
Options Filesystem Unmount (1) /dev/fd0

Options Filesystem Mount (1) /dev/fd0 (2) /usr/diane/mnt

RUN file: Multiplan   parameters:           output:

Enter a filename or select from list
/usr/diane                                     date   time   XENIX
```

4. Press the RETURN key.

Multiplan will appear on your screen. When you exit Multiplan, the Visual Shell main command screen will be redisplayed.

Example 2: Running a Command With the Filter Menu

You can sort a list of names and send the sorted output to a file named *myfile* by using the **Run** command with the **Sort** filter. To create a list of names, you'll invoke the **cat** command using **Run**. The **cat** command copies keyboard input directly to a filter or file. Follow these steps:

1. Choose the **Run** command from the main command menu.
2. Fill in the **Run** command menu with the word “cat” in the “file:” command field. Go to the “output:” field and place a bar (|) symbol in it. Your screen should look like this:

```

+---/usr/diane-----+
|      [.]          [...]      .profile      [forms]      |
|      templ        [letters]  [mnt]          |
|
|
|
|
|
|
|
|
|
|
+---forms-----modified---date---+
Options Filesystem Mount (1) /dev/fd0 (2) /usr/diane/mnt
Run (1) Multiplan (2) (3)
RUN file: cat          parameters:          output: |
Enter a filename or press | to view filter menu
/usr/diane                                     date   time   XENIX

```

3. Press the RETURN key. The **Filter** menu will appear.
4. Choose the **Sort** filter. The Visual Shell will display the **Filter Sort** menu. Since an A-Z sort is the default, you do not need to change this command field.
5. Go to the “output:” field. Type the filename *myfile*. Your screen should look like this:

steps:

1. Choose **Run** from the main command menu.
2. Type the XENIX **sort** command in the “file:” field.
3. Type “beta” in the “parameters:” command field.
4. Type a bar symbol (|) in the “output:” field to access the **Filter** menu.
5. Select **Run** from the **Filter** menu.
6. Type “unique.s” in the “file:” command field to access your filter.
7. Press RETURN.

The Visual Shell will display the *beta* file, sorted and without duplicate entries, on the screen.

3.8 Sending and Receiving Mail

You send and receive mail with the **Mail** command on the main command menu. When you choose the **Mail** command, a **Mail** menu appears. There are two commands on the **Mail** menu: **Read** and **Send**. Use the **Read** command to read any electronic mail you receive; use the **Send** command to send messages to other users of the system.

There are several commands you can perform while you are in **Mail**: deleting messages, saving messages in a file, editing a message you are composing, and canceling a message. These commands are discussed in the examples below. For more information about **Mail**, see the *XENIX User's Guide*.

Example

To read mail:

When you see the message “Mail” on the status line, choose the **Mail** command. A **Mail** menu will appear. Choose **Read**. A list of your mail messages will appear on the screen. To read message 1, type 1 and press RETURN. To read message 3, type 3 and press RETURN. When you have finished reading your mail, press CTRL-D to return to the main command menu.

To delete a message:

To delete a message from your mailbox, type:

dnumber

where *number* is the number of the message you wish to delete. If you decide you want to save a deleted message, you can restore it *before you quit Mail* by typing:

unumber

where *number* is the number of the message you want restored. You cannot restore a message after you have exited **Mail**.

To save a message in a file:

To save a message in a file, type:

snumber pathname

where *number* is the number of the message being saved, and *pathname* is the pathname of the file in which you want to save the message.

To edit a message:

If you wish to edit a message you are composing, you can enter the **ed** editor from **Mail** by typing:

-e

on a line by itself. See the *XENIX User's Guide* for information on how to use **ed**.

When you exit the editor you will be back in **Mail**.

To cancel a message:

If, while composing a message, you decide not to send it, you can cancel the message by pressing the INTERRUPT key twice. After you have pressed INTERRUPT twice, you will return to the **Mail** menu.

To send mail:

1. Choose **Mail** from the main command menu.
2. Choose the **Send** command.

You are now in the XENIX mail system. To send mail, type the user's name in the "to" command field. Press RETURN. Next, type the subject in the "Subject:" field. Press RETURN. Then, type a message. When you press CTRL-D, XENIX will send your message to the specified user or users.

To exit Mail:

If you are reading mail, press CTRL-D to exit **Mail** and return to the main command menu. If you are sending mail, you will return to the main command menu automatically; don't press CTRL-D again or you will log yourself out.

Example

This example sends the message, "Hello there" to users Sue and Joe.

1. Choose **Mail** from the main command menu.
2. Choose **Send**.
3. Type "Sue" and "Joe" in the "to:" command field.
4. Fill in the "Subject:" field. Press RETURN.
5. Type, "Hello there" in the message area.
6. Press RETURN.
7. Press CTRL-D.

When you exit the mail system, you will be returned to the XENIX Visual Shell. For more information on how to send and receive mail, refer to the *XENIX User's Guide* for instructions.

3.9 Getting Help: The Help Command

The Visual Shell includes a special **Help** command to assist you while using the XENIX operating system. This **Help** information is always available to you.

To access **Help** text, the **Help** command from the main command menu. You will see a **Help** menu that looks like this:

```
INTRODUCTION

You may ask for help at any time during your work....

If you need...

When you...

Right now...

You may...

HELP: Resume Next Previous Introduction
      Commands Keyboard Filters Menus
Select option or type command letter
/usr/diane                                date    time    XENIX
```

Use this menu to view various parts of the **Help** information. If you press “C” (for **Commands**), a Command Overview appears on the screen. This describes how to choose commands with the Visual Shell. When you press “N” (for **Next**), more Command Overview help text is shown. You can use the **Next** command when the **Help** text is longer than one screen.

The following list describes the **Help** commands:

Resume	Resumes state of screen before you asked for help.
Next	Moves Help text forward by one screenful.
Previous	Moves Help text backward by one screenful.
Introduction	Moves you to the beginning of Help text.
Commands	Gives you Visual Shell command information.
Keyboard	Tells you how to use the keyboard.
Filters	Describes operating system filters and command piping, and how to use filter menus.
Menus	Illustrates how to change command menus.

You can access Visual Shell information with the **Help** command. For example, to find out which keys perform which functions, select the **Help** command, then type “K” (for **Keyboard**). The beginning of the list of keys appears. Type “N” (for **Next**) to view the rest of the list.

You can also access the **Help** command by pressing the question mark (?) key while you are selecting a Visual Shell command or filling in a command field. The example below illustrates this use of the **Help** command.

Example

To access **Help** text on the **Copy** command, follow these steps:

1. Choose the **Copy** command by highlighting “Copy” using the SPACEBAR and pressing RETURN; do not type “C.”
2. When the **Copy** menu appears, press the question mark (?) key.

The screen display will be replaced by **Help** information on the **Copy** command. Your screen should look like this:

```
COPY

Copies directories and files.


HELP: Resume Next Previous Introduction
      Commands Keyboard Filters Menus
Select option or type command letter
/usr/diane                                date                                XENIX
```

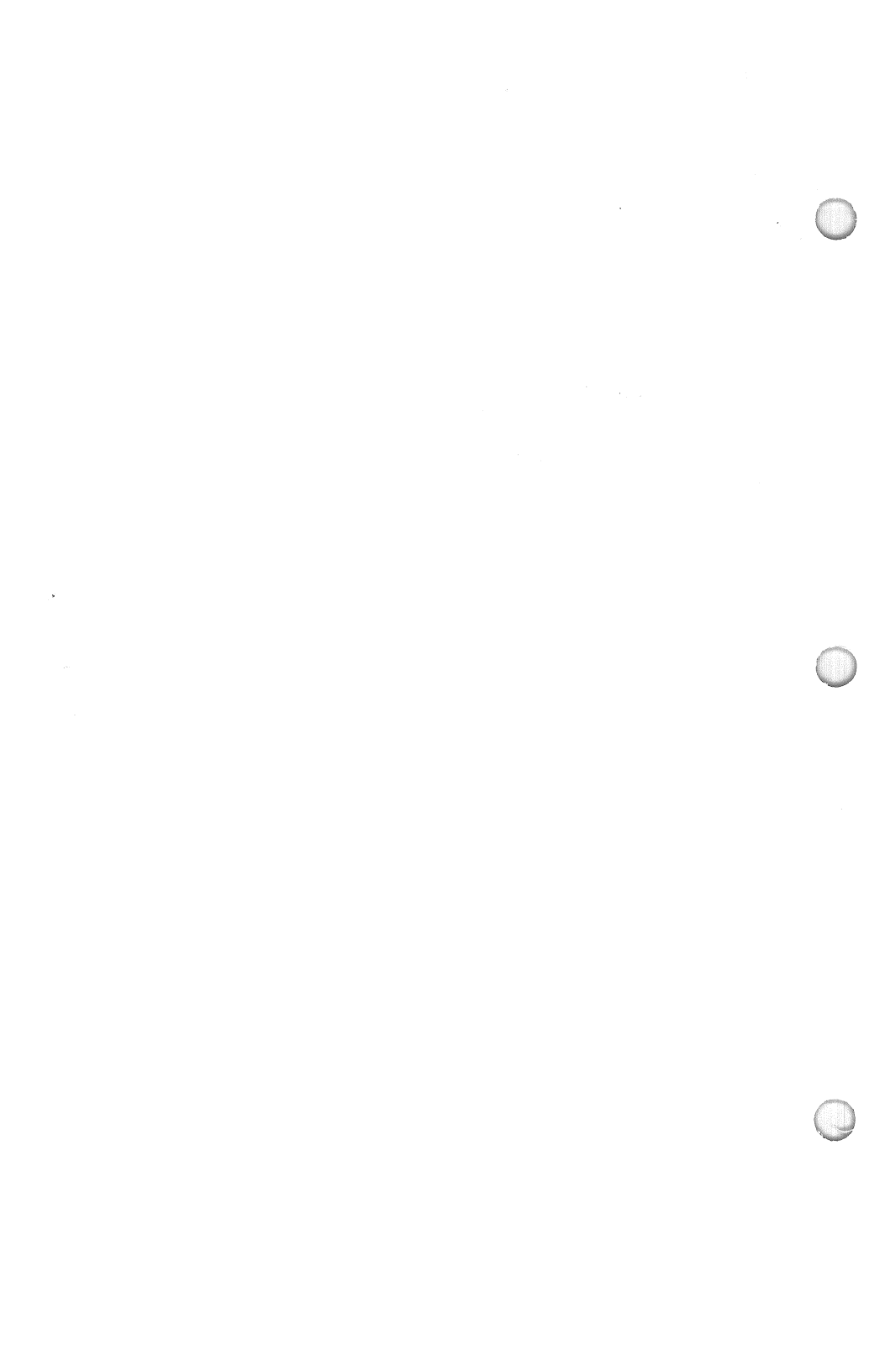
The information on the **C**opy command describes what happened when you copied the file *temp1* to *temp2* earlier in this manual. The **H**elp menu appears at the bottom of the screen. You can use the “N” (for **N**ext) command to view more of the **H**elp text, or you can choose any of the subjects that you want to learn about. When you press “R” (for **R**esume), the main command menu is redisplayed.

The Visual Shell asks you to confirm that you want to quit. To quit, type “Y” (for Yes). If you press any other character or number, the Visual Shell will return to the main command menu. When you type “Y”, the screen will clear and you will have exited the Visual Shell. To restart the shell, press the RETURN key.

To quit the session, follow these steps:

1. Choose the **Quit** command from the main command menu.
2. The **Quit** screen will appear. It asks you to “Type Y to confirm:”. Type “Y”.

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Chapter 4

Using Advanced Features

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4.1 Introduction

The Visual Shell is more than just an operating system interface; it is designed to help you enter commands and perform functions efficiently. Two Visual Shell features give you flexibility and power: the window and a modifiable menu structure. You will learn about the window and how to change Visual Shell menus in this chapter.

4.2 Using the Window

The Visual Shell can set aside a *window* at the top of your screen in which you can display and access information. You can manipulate directories and text files in this window. The window can be permanent or temporary. A permanent window is one that has been explicitly opened and will remain open (with necessary redrawing) until explicitly closed. This is accomplished with the **Window** command. Refer to Section 4.3 for information on opening permanent windows on the screen. A temporary window will disappear after the next command is processed.

4.2.1 Showing the Directory

Just as you can view text files in the window, you can use the direction keys on your keyboard to view directories in the window. (Refer to Chapter 5, “Key Directory,” for information on the direction keys UP, DOWN, LEFT, and RIGHT.) When you use one of these keys, a temporary window appears on your screen and remains only until you execute a Visual Shell command.

To display a directory, press one of the direction keys when the main command menu appears on the screen. A temporary window will be drawn in the upper portion of the screen.

The window contains a directory listing for your working directory. Two kinds of information are shown: names of files and names of directories. Directories and subdirectories are shown in brackets ([]), and each executable file is preceded by an asterisk (*). Text files are not marked in any special way.

You can use the direction keys to select filenames and directory names in the window. The bottom border of a window always contains information about the selected directory or file. The border tells you the name of the directory (or file), its size in bytes, and the date it was last modified. For example:

```
_____myfile_____ 33 bytes _____modified Aug. 2, 1985
```

Two special keys are used with the window. These keys are the equal sign (=) and the hyphen (-). For simplicity, we will call these the SHOW and GOAWAY keys. If the cursor is highlighting a directory, you can press the SHOW (=) key to see the listing for that subdirectory displayed in the window. Pressing the GOAWAY (-) key returns the display to the parent directory. You can always access a parent directory by pressing the GOAWAY key. Using these two keys, you can change your current working directory. This is another way to perform a View command on a directory. (Refer to Section 3.4.2 in Chapter 3, "Using the Visual Shell," for more information.) Notice that there are several subdirectories in your working directory. To view the directory named */usr/diane/forms*, follow these steps:

1. Use the direction keys to select the *[forms]* subdirectory name.
2. Press the SHOW (=) key to view the */usr/diane/forms* directory. Your screen will look like this:

```
+---/usr/diane-----+
|  [.]                [...]                [memo]          |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
|                                                            |
+---+-----modified---date---+

COMMANE: Copy Delete Edit Help Mail Name
          Options Print Quit Run View Window
Select option or type command letter
/usr/diane/forms                                     date   time   XENIX
```

3. Press the GOAWAY (-) key to redisplay the */usr/diane* directory in the window.

4.2.2 Showing Text Files

You can also view text files in the window with the SHOW and GOAWAY keys. To view a text file, press one of the direction keys so that the working directory is displayed in the window. To view a text file, select the name of

the file you want to view. Press the SHOW key. The directory will disappear and be replaced by the text file you selected. You can use the scrolling keys to view the file. (Refer to Chapter 5, “Key Directory,” for information on keys that scroll through files.) When you press the GOAWAY key, the working directory is redisplayed in the window.

Note

You can only “show” text files that reside in the directory that is currently displayed on the screen. To display other text files, either change directories or use the **View** command and specify a full pathname.

Example

To view the *temp1* file in your working directory, follow these steps:

1. Press one of the direction keys when you see the main command menu on the screen. Your working directory will appear in the window.
2. Select the filename *temp1*.
3. Press the SHOW key.

The *temp1* file will be displayed in the window. To return to your working directory, press the GOAWAY key.

4.3 Expanding the Window: The Window Command

Windows that appear in response to pressing a direction key are *temporary* windows that disappear after the next command is pressed. The **Window** command can be used to create a permanent window on the screen, and to increase the size of the window.

To create a permanent window that is smaller than the default 15-line window, choose the **Window** command from the main command menu. The **Window** menu will appear. This menu asks you whether you want to redraw the window after each command. The default is “Yes”. To establish a smaller window, go to the “height in lines:” command field. Type a number from 1 through 14. (The window cannot be more than 15 lines long.) When you press the RETURN key, the main command menu will be redisplayed. A permanent window will appear on the screen until you close it with the **Window** command.

Visual Shell

To close the window, choose the **Window** command from the main command menu. Choose the “No” option in the “redraw:” command field. Press RETURN. The display will return to the main command menu, and the window will not appear until you press a direction key.

Example

To create a permanent 10-line window on the screen, follow these steps:

1. Choose the **Window** command from the main command menu.
2. Go to the “redraw:” command field and choose “Yes”.
3. Go to the “height in lines:” command field. Type the value 10. Your screen should look like this:

```
+-----/usr/diane-----+
|      [.i]                [..]          .profile      [forms]
|      templ               [letters]     [mnt]          myfile
|
|
|
|
|
|
|
|
|
|
+-----forms-----modified---date---+

WINDOW redraw: (Yes)No    height in lines: 10

Enter an integer
/usr/diane                                date   time      XENIX
```

4. Press the RETURN key.

The main command menu will be redisplayed. A window 10 lines long will appear in the upper part of the screen. To close this permanent window, choose the **Window** command and go to the “redraw:” command field. Choose “No”. When you press RETURN, the main command menu will be redisplayed and the window will be closed.

4.4 Using the Window with Simple Commands

One of the advantages of using a window is that you can fill in command menus with filenames and directory names by selecting them in the window. The following example duplicates the **Copy File** command described in Section 3.3.3 in Chapter 3, “Using the Visual Shell,” when the *temp1* file was copied to a file named *temp2*.

Example:

1. In the main command menu, type “C” (for **Copy**). The **Copy** menu will appear on the screen.
2. Select **File** from the **Copy** menu.
3. The cursor should be in the “from:” command field. Do not type the filename *temp1*. Instead, press the direction keys so that the working directory appears in the window. The following figure illustrates what your screen should look like:

+---/usr/diane-----+ <table> <tr> <td>[.]</td> <td>[..]</td> <td>.profile</td> <td>[forms]</td> </tr> <tr> <td>templ</td> <td>[letters]</td> <td>[mnt]</td> <td>myfile</td> </tr> </table>				[.]	[..]	.profile	[forms]	templ	[letters]	[mnt]	myfile
[.]	[..]	.profile	[forms]								
templ	[letters]	[mnt]	myfile								
+---forms-----modified---date---+											
COPY FILE from: to: Enter one or more filenames or select from list /usr/diane date time XENIX											

- Now, using the direction keys, select the filename *templ* in the window. Notice that as you press the direction keys, the command field changes in the **Copy** menu. Each filename that is selected in the window appears in the “from:” field at the bottom of the screen.
- When the name *templ* appears in the “from:” field of the **Copy** menu, go to the “to:” field.
- Type the filename *temp2*.
- Press RETURN.

Output from the **Copy** command (“Copy file (1) templ (2) temp2”) will appear in the command output section of the command screen.

Both filenames and directory names can be selected to fill in command menus. Experiment with various commands by using the window to fill in the command menus.

4.5 Changing the Menu

You can modify menu commands (except those in **Help**) at any time. While in a menu (for example, the main command menu), you can change the commands on the screen by pressing the MODIFY (@) key. When you press @,